Soundings

PROPOSAL

Self-service test data generator

Project	Internal Tools
Idea	TOOLS-3
Status	Proposal
Owner	Kenji Watanabe
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Score	Aggregate score 3.7 from 3 evaluations

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Summary

Generate realistic, anonymised test accounts and orders on demand.

Problem

Every team builds its own test accounts. QA spends about a day a sprint on it, and the payments team copies production data by hand, which the DPO wants stopped.

Solution

A small service in the developer portal that generates **realistic, anonymised** customers, orders and payment methods on demand:

- pick a scenario ("returning customer with a failed payment")
- get the accounts in staging within a minute
- everything generated is deleted after 30 days

Effort & rollout

Two developers for six weeks, then QA moves its scripts over. Roll out to QA first, then payments, then everyone.

Risks

- Generated data drifts from real data: QA reviews the scenarios each quarter.
- Teams keep copying production: we turn that access off once the generator covers their cases.

The ask

Not written yet.

Research and consultation

Not already being done elsewhere

QA has a script for orders only; the payments team copies production by hand. Nothing shared.

Answered by Kenji Watanabe on 10 September 2026

Departments or teams consulted

QA (test automation), 2 Sep: will help with the order rules. Payments: need card numbers that pass Luhn but never charge.

Answered by Kenji Watanabe on 10 September 2026

Data protection considered

Data protection officer, 3 Sep: fine as long as nothing is copied from production; generated data only.

Answered by Kenji Watanabe on 10 September 2026